

外研社杯·国才杯·2017 年阅读大赛复赛第一场

Questions 1-3 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: Read the following quotes. Match the quotes with the people. Please note there are two extra options you do not need

A. Ralph Waldo Emerson	1. What' s in a name? That which we call a rose by any other word would smell as sweet.
B. Oscar Wilde	2. The reasonable man adapts himself to the world; the unreasonable one persists in trying to adapt the world to himself
C. William Shakespeare	3. We are all in the gutter, but some of us are looking at the stars.
D. Francis Bacon	
E. George Bernard Shaw	

Question 4 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

That glass of wine or pint of beer you enjoy with dinner every night might come with an added benefit—a lower risk of type 2 diabetes, a new Danish study contends.

The researchers found that men who had 14 drinks each week and women who had nine drinks a week appeared to have the lowest risk of type 2 diabetes, compared to nondrinkers or people who drank more heavily, said senior researcher Janne Tolstrup.

People received the most benefit if they spread those drinks out during the week, rather than downing them all in one or two binges, Tolstrup added.

“ _____ seemed to play a role for the risk of diabetes,” Tolstrup said. “Drinking frequency was important, as those who were drinking three to four times per week had lower risk as compared to those drinking only once per week—regardless of the total weekly amount.”

4. What may be the missing words?

- A) Drinking duration
- B) Drinking quantity
- C) Drinking pattern
- D) Drinking culture

Question 5 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the question according to the text.

A hundred years ago today a man died. He died immortal. He departed laden with years, laden with works, laden with the most illustrious and the most fearful of responsibilities, the responsibility of the human conscience informed and rectified. He went cursed and blessed, cursed by the past, blessed by the future; and these, gentlemen, are the two superb forms of glory. On his deathbed he had, on the one hand, the acclaim of contemporaries and of posterity; on the other, that triumph of hooting and of hate which the implacable past bestows upon those who have combated it. He was more than a man; he was an age. He had exercised a function and fulfilled a mission. He had been evidently chosen for the work which he had done, by the supreme will, which manifests itself as visibly in the laws of destiny as in the laws of nature.

5. The text is most probably taken from _____.

- A) a novel B) a diary C) an autobiography D) an oration

Question 6 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*



City trees offer a host of benefits. These include helping soak up stormwater that might otherwise drain into rivers (carrying pollution with it). Trees also provide cooling shade. They even soak up carbon dioxide, a greenhouse gas. At the same time, these trees release oxygen into the air.

But oxygen is far from the only gas that trees and certain other green plants release into the air. One of these chemicals is a hydrocarbon known as isoprene. It can react with combustion pollutants, such as nitrogen oxides. The result is the formation of ozone. A component of smog, ozone can irritate the lungs and aggravate airway diseases, such as asthma.

6. According to the text, what can city trees emit?

- A) Isoprene. B) Carbon dioxide. C) Ozone. D) Nitrogen oxides.

Question 7 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Rampant road building has shattered the Earth’ s land into 600,000 fragments, most of which are too tiny to support significant wildlife, a new study has revealed.

The researchers warn roadless areas are disappearing and that urgent action is needed to protect these last wildernesses, which help provide vital natural services to humanity such as clean water and air.

The impact of roads extends far beyond the roads themselves, the scientists said, by enabling forest destruction, pollution, the splintering of animal populations and the introduction of deadly pests. New roads also pave the way to further exploitation by humans, such as poaching or mining, and new infrastructure.



7. What is the best title for this text?

- A) Tiny Fragments Shattered by Road Building C) The Pros and Cons of Road Building B) The Stunning Effect of Roads on Nature D) Current Conditions of Roadless Areas

Question 8 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

Hillman’ s portrait of Bill Richmond from 1812

Who was the first African American sports superstar? Ask any boxing fan and they might tell you it was Jack Johnson, a fierce fighter who terrorized opponents on his way to becoming the first black heavyweight champion in 1908. However, 100 years before “The Galveston Giant,” there was Bill Richmond: a former slave who used both his brains and brawn to revolutionize both the sport and public perception of African Americans in general. In 2017, as part of a larger archaeological investigation of a former London burial site known as St. James’ Garden, researchers began the hunt for Richmond’ s unmarked grave, in the hopes of shedding a light on this unlikelyst of sports stars.



8. What do we know about Bill Richmond from the text?

- A) He was the first African American superstar. C) He was an influential sportsman in the 19th century.
B) He was much more successful than Jack Johnson. D) He was considered “the Galveston Giant” .

Question 9 (Suggested completion time: 2 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text and answer the question according to the text.*

“Dear Gregory,” I muttered, and crept nearer to him for warmth. He was talking still, and again about our mother, when I fell asleep. In an instant—or so it seemed—there were many voices about me—many faces hovering round me—the sweet luxury of warmth was stealing into every part of me. I was in my own little bed at home. I am thankful to say, my first word was “Gregory?”

A look passed from one to another—my father's stern old face strove in vain to keep its sternness; his mouth quivered, his eyes filled slowly with unwonted tears.

"I would have given him half my land—I would have blessed him as my son, —oh God! I would have knelt at his feet, and asked him to forgive my hardness of heart."

I heard no more. A whirl came through my brain, catching me back to death.

9. What can be inferred from the text?

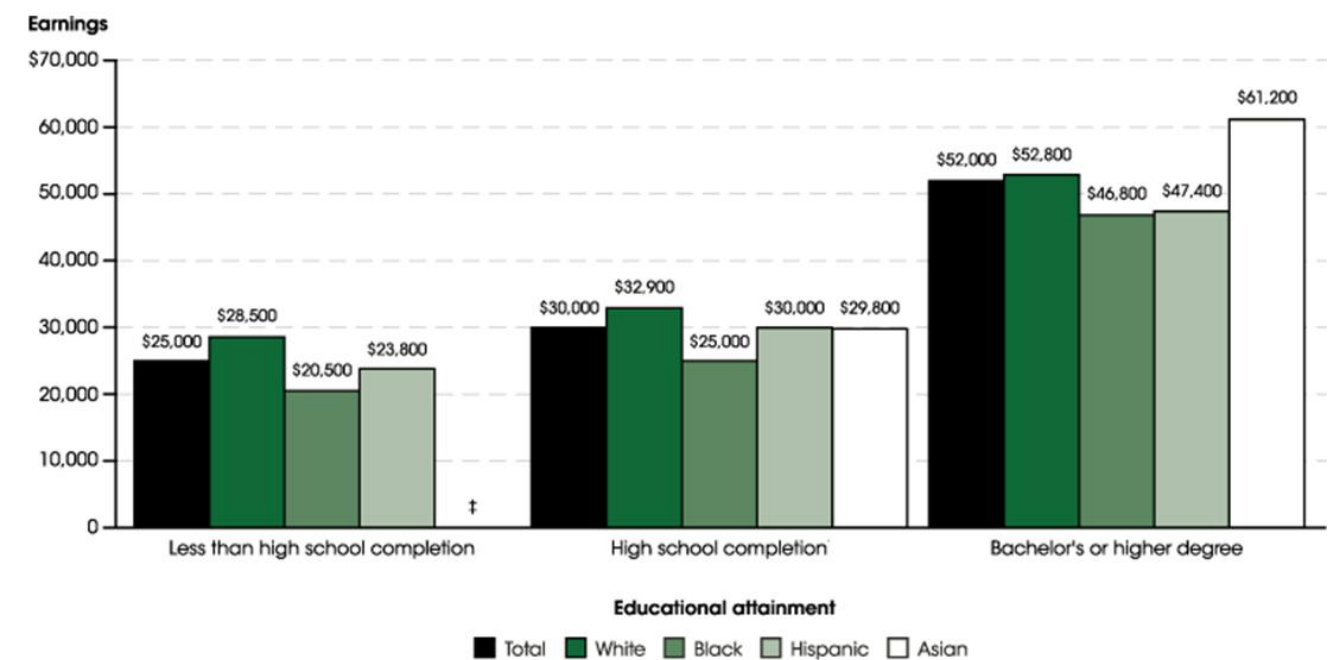
- A) "My father" was strict with his son.
- B) I was disappointed in "my father" .
- C) "I" have no feeling towards "my father" .
- D) Gregory left because of "my father" .

Question 10 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: The following bar chart shows the median annual earnings of full-time year-round workers 25 to 64 years old, by educational attainment and race/ethnicity in 2014. Answer the question according to the information in the chart.

10. Which of the following is an INCORRECT description of the chart?

- A) The median annual earnings of Black full-time workers aged 25–34 with a high school degree are lower than those with a bachelor's or higher degree.



⁴ ‡: Reporting standards not met (too few cases for a reliable estimate).

SOURCE: U.S. Department of Commerce, Census Bureau, Current Population Survey (CPS), "Annual Social and Economic Supplement," 2015.

- B) In general, higher levels of educational attainment are associated with higher median annual earnings for 25- to 34-year-old full-time workers in all racial/ethnic groups.
- C) Among the full-time workers aged 25–34 with a high school diploma, the White show higher median annual earnings than their Black, Hispanic, and Asian peers.
- D) Among those with a bachelor’ s or higher degree, Asian full-time workers aged 25–34 are the only group whose median annual earnings are higher than those of the total.

Question 11 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Read the definition of the following logical fallacy. Answer the question according to the definition.

11. Which of the following provides a typical example of *availability heuristic*?

- A) Whatever your reasons are for buying that gift, they’ ve got to be ridiculous. You said yourself that you got the idea for buying it from last night’ s fortune cookie. Cookies can’ t think!
- B) That cannot be Senator Smith there in the videotape going into her apartment. If it were, he’ d be a liar about not knowing her. He’ s not the kind of man who would lie. He’ s a member of my congregation.
- C) What she says about Johannes Kepler’ s astronomy of the 1600s must be just so much garbage. Do you realize she’ s only fifteen years old?
- D) I just saw a video of a woman dying by fire in a car crash because she was unable to unbuckle her seat belt as the flames increased in intensity. So, I am deciding today no longer to wear a seat belt when I drive.

Question 12 (Suggested completion time: 4 minutes)

Directions: Look at the following picture and answer the question.

Availability Heuristic

As to *availability heuristic*, decision makers “assess the frequency of a class or the probability of an event by the ease with which instances or occurrences can be brought to mind.” Usually this heuristic works quite well; all things being equal, common events are easier to remember or imagine than are uncommon events. By relying on availability to estimate frequency and probability, decision makers are able to simplify what might otherwise be very difficult judgments.



12. Which of the following logical fallacies does the picture illustrate?

- A) **Appeal to Hypocrisy:** This fallacy involves countering someone's argument by pointing out that it conflicts with his or her own past actions or statements. Thus, by answering a charge with a charge, it diverts attention from the argument at hand to the person making it.
- B) **Guilt by Association:** This is a fallacy in which a person is said to be guilty of error because of the group he or she associates with. The fallacy occurs when we unfairly try to change the issue to be about the speaker's circumstances rather than about the speaker's actual argument.
- C) **Appeal to Bandwagon:** This argument uses the fact that many people (or even a majority) believe in something as evidence that it must be true. This type of argument has often impeded the widespread acceptance of a pioneering idea.
- D) **Ad Hominem:** An argument that attacks a person rather than the argument he or she is making, with the intention of diverting the discussion and discrediting their argument.

Question 13 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: *Read the following text and answer the question according to the text.*

The enormous distances between stars are not spaces entirely devoid of matter. The interstellar spaces are filled with "dust": very low density matter. This miniscule amount of matter, spread over almost infinite distances, acts like a curtain obscuring the stars that lie behind. If it were not for this material we would see no dark patches in the sky at night: **the sky would be entirely covered with stars.**

13. What roles do the two parts in bold play in the text?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A) The first is a fact that the author thinks is important in explaining a certain phenomenon. The second is a result that the author would expect if that fact were not true. | C) The first is a suggestion that the author wishes to dispute. The second is a hypothesis that the author wishes to explain. |
| B) The first is an established fact that the author wishes to explain. The second is a | D) The first is a speculation that the author wishes to justify. The second is a consequence that |

consequence of accepting this fact.

would result if that speculation is not true.

E) The first is the main point the author wishes to make. The second is a hypothetical result of accepting that point.

Question 14 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about a famous experiment in history. Answer the question according to the text.*

The Asch Conformity Experiment

The Asch Experiment is a famous example of the temptation to conform during group situations. It's a series of experiments conducted by psychologist Solomon Asch in the 1950s. In each of the experiments, one subject is placed in a room full of actors. The person conducting the experiment held up an image with three numbered lines and asked each person in the room to identify the longest line. The actors purposely chose the incorrect line in order to determine whether the subject would answer honestly or simply go along with the group answer.

The Experiment has been repeated many times over the years with students and non-students, old and young, and in groups of different sizes and different settings. The results are consistently the same with one-third to one-half of the participants making a judgment contrary to fact, yet in conformity with the group, demonstrating the strong power of social influences

14. Which of the following could NOT be demonstrated by this scientific experiment?

- A) Knowledge could be constructed and disseminated in the way that is shown in the Experiment.
- B) The responses of the subjects revealed strong individual differences rather than conformity to group preferences.
- C) Very often even simple objective facts cannot withstand the distorting pressure of group influence.
- D) The behavior and expectations of others can greatly influence us and shape how we think and act.

Question 15 (Suggested completion time: 3 minutes)

Directions: *Read the text about a course description. Answer the question according to the text.*

Course Description

The course provides a comprehensive introduction to key issues and findings in object recognition in experimental, neural, computational, and applied domains. It emphasizes the problem of representation, exploring the issue of how 3-D objects should be encoded so as to efficiently recognize them from 2-D images. The second half of the course focuses on an ecologically important instance of the general object recognition problem. It describes experimental studies of human face recognition performance and recent attempts to mimic this ability in artificial computational systems.

15. What is the course name according to the description?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A) Object and Face Recognition | C) Computational Neuroscience |
| B) Cognitive & Behavioral Genetics of Human | D) Artificial Intelligence & Computational Recognition |

Questions 16-17 (Suggested completion time: 5 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.



On a late Wednesday afternoon in North Sydney, my entire office knocked off work early to play a game of barefoot bowls in the summer sun. This is a relaxed, Aussie version of traditional lawn bowls, so when it was the boss' round to buy drinks, he just called in a sub. While Dave was at the bar (not Mr. or Sir; just "Dave"), his game was openly mocked by 20-something colleagues with their suit trousers rolled up, a joke that only grew louder when he returned with a tray full of cold beers and joined in on the jest. We may have been at the second oldest bowls club in New South Wales, but there were no stiff white jackets. Just bare feet and beers. Everyone was called "mate". Every second word was abbreviated.

This kind of scene is nothing out of the ordinary. Australians have long been known for having a relaxed and casual attitude to life—everywhere from the Sydney bowls clubs to the barstools of Outback pubs to the surf beaches of Victoria.

According to Dr Tanya King, senior lecturer in anthropology from Victoria's Deakin University, "it's Australians' egalitarianism, sense of humour and informal language that are most commonly cited as examples of this attitude".

16. According to the text, why is Dave NOT "Mr." or "Sir" but just "Dave" ?



A) Because it is a proper way to name the waiter.

C) Because the person is unqualified for the title.

B) Because it is a casual way to call the boss.

D) Because the person is willing to well behave.

17. What does "this attitude" in Paragraph 3 possibly refer to?

A) Approvable. B) Liberal. C) Contented. D) Laid-back.

Questions 18-19 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

The tiny bump on the back of Dave Williams' hand is barely noticeable—most people would miss the rice-grain-sized lump between his thumb and forefinger at first. It is only when the 33-year-old opens his front door with a wave of his hand that it becomes clear something strange is going on.

Embedded under Williams' skin is a microchip implant—an electronic circuit inside a pill-shaped glass capsule—that can be used much like a contactless credit card.

Williams, a systems engineer at software firm Mozilla, is one of a growing number of so-called "biohackers" who are choosing to augment their bodies with technology. In Williams' case, he chose to implant a radio frequency identification (RFID) chip into his hand out of curiosity.

The procedure has essentially turned him into a walking contactless smart card. By registering the tag with a variety of devices, he can use it to trigger certain functions, such as transferring his contact details to a friend's mobile phone.

"I have the world's worst memory," says Williams. The fact that he now has a gadget on him at all times that opens doors and unlocks his computer—one that he can't leave at home or forget—is a huge advantage.

"It's also fun to give someone my number and email address by touching their phone to my hand."

This new level of convenience is one of the biggest draws for those installing implantable RFID implants, and the number of people experimenting with the devices is growing. One manufacturer of the chips, Dangerous Things, told CNBC last year that it had sold more than 10,000 of them, along with the kits needed to install them under the skin. But as they become more widespread, _____19_____.

This week, a vending machine company based in River Falls, Wisconsin, announced that it is offering to implant chips into its employees' hands. Three Square Market says a \$300 (£230) chip will allow workers to open doors, log in to computers and even purchase food in their canteen. Already 50 employees have signed up to have an implant.

They' re not the only ones to do so. Cincinnati-based video surveillance firm CityWatcher embedded the gadgets under the skin of two employees in 2006, and technology incubator EpiCentre said it would be offering the chips to its members in Stockholm earlier this year.

BioHax International, which is supplying the chips to Three Square Market, says dozens of other firms around the world—including some multinationals—are looking to implement similar schemes in their workplaces. The trend has sparked alarm over whether wireless implants could be used to keep tabs on employees by tracking their movements, and civil liberties groups warn they could be used to intrude upon privacy in other ways. Many of those already working with the implants, however, are baffled by this concern.

18. Which of the following statements is TRUE according to the text?

- A) Williams, as a biohacker, personally experiences the experiment with no commercial purposes. C) CityWatcher and BioHax International are pioneers in this microchip technology.
- B) The bump on Dave Williams' hand is an implanted contactless credit card microchip. D) Employees at Three Square Market have been implanted with chips regardless of their unwillingness.

19. Which of the following best fits in the numbered space in Paragraph 6?

- A) concerns are growing about what the trend might mean for personal privacy and security C) implantable devices can' t be easily removed or in this case even switched off
- B) it' s not a huge leap from having this technology in our pockets to having it under our skin. D) RFID technology is assumed to be accessible to companies and products in all walks of life

Questions 20-21 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text about note-taking and answer the questions according to the text.



Many students bring laptops to class, thinking that typing their notes will make them better learners than the "old-fashioned" method of writing by hand.

They' re wrong.

Taking notes is not about transcribing what is said during lecture. It' s about processing the information in a way that helps you pull out what' s important and make new connections. Mueller and Oppenheimer (2014) found that the problem with taking notes on a laptop is that we type TOO FAST. Because many of us type almost as fast as a lecturer presents, we write everything down. We shouldn' t: it interferes with listening to the lecture, taking in the core message, and deeper processing.

And that' s if we stay on task and don' t drift onto YouTube during class. (Side note: My students consistently complain that they are distracted by the tech use of students around them. Pulling out your phone or,

especially, checking a laptop screen distracts not just you, but students next to and behind you.) Most students who use tech in class report they' re distracted by it. If you' ve ever sat at the back of a classroom and looked at the screens in front of you, you know it' s true.

The Advantages of Writing by Hand

One advantage of taking notes by hand is that it slows you down, forcing you to listen more carefully and condense the information to get it down on paper.

Another is that it activates your brain in a different way than typing does. Frank Wilson wrote a fascinating book on hands, in which he argues that brain development is intimately linked to what we do with our hands.

Playing with legos and blocks, doing arts and crafts, and spending time in Maker spaces causes us to develop better tools for integrating and processing three dimensional information and problem-solving tasks.

Cornell Notes

For those of you more committed to daily note-taking (or more organized) than me, the Cornell Note-Taking System does something similar on a daily basis. The definitive guide is on their learning center' s webpage: The Cornell Note-Taking System. It basically suggests you divide your paper into three sections:

1. A large section on the right 2/3 of the page where you take notes on the fly.
2. A column on the left third of the page for comments. Here you pull out key vocabulary, make connections, ask questions, and PROCESS. You can do this during or immediately after class.
3. The bottom inch or two of each page. Here is where you read your notes and pull out the big points.

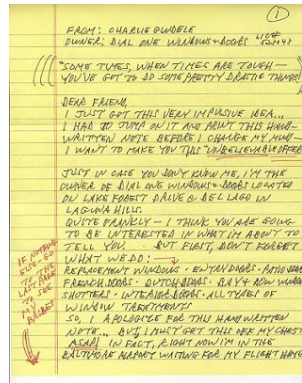
You' ll notice the similarity between this (and many other note-taking systems) and my own disorganized process. PROCESSING IS KEY. Writing it down is only a way of helping your memory work more easily. You then need to consolidate and reconsolidate the memory in multiple forms to make it easier to retrieve.

20. Compared with typing on laptops, note-taking by hand _____.

- | | |
|--|---|
| A) distracts students from lectures to the notes | C) hinders students from comprehending lectures |
| B) facilitates the process of information processing | D) is one of the optimal choices for quick learners |

21. According to the text, which of the following is a standardized example of Cornell Notes?

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A)

John O. Student
Biology 101
April 1, 2000

Phylum	Arthropods
subphylum	Chelicerata
Chelicerata	2 parts: - prothorax - opisthomeria
exanthes	scorpions, spiders, mites, ticks
Prothorax	sensory, feeding, and locomotor
Opisthomeria	cuticular
Cheliceræ	• pincerlike or chelate • used for feeding • first pair or appendages
Pedipalps	• second pair of appendages • used for sensory purposes
	feeding locomotion reproduction

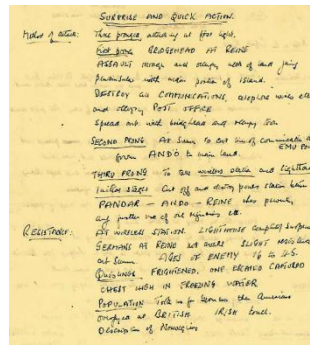
Phylum arthropods is made up of subphylum chelicerata.

Subphylum chelicerata is characterized by two parts called prothorax and opisthomeria. The prothorax and Cephalothorax are sensory, feeding, and locomotor.

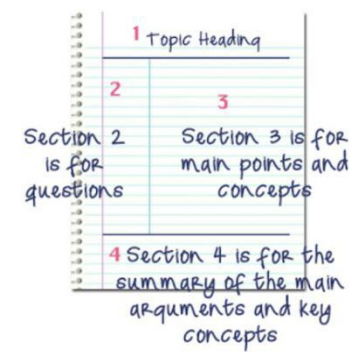
The cheliceræ is the first appendage and refers to the pincers.

The pedipalps are the 2nd pair of appendages, and they are used for sensory purposes: feeding, locomotion, and reproduction.

B)



C)



D)

Questions 22-23 (Suggested completion time: 6 minutes)

Directions: Read the text and answer the questions according to the text.

How to Enforce Life Skills That Tech Might be Eroding

You started with the best intentions. Your kid needed a laptop for homework. Your tween needed a phone to text you after school. You wanted a Fitbit to lose a few extra pounds. But now, you look around and devices are plugged into every nook and cranny in your home.

Everyone's staring, tapping, tracking. While you're grateful for things like Google Maps and Netflix that make your life easier and more fun, something feels off.

It's the basics that are missing: courtesy, conversation, being bored, and appreciating simple pleasures.

But all hope is not lost. You may have to take another look at how your family is using tech and make adjustments based on your values. But you can do it. Here is one way tech has ***nibbled away at*** valuable life skills and experiences, and what you can do about it.

Home Assistants vs. Manners



If you are one of the millions of households in the United States with Alexa or Google Home, you may have noticed an unfortunate side effect of using the device: a lack of enforced courtesy. Kids (and adults) shout commands at the device: “Play Beyoncé!” or “What’s the weather?!” The devices do not require a “please” or “thank you,” and the more lifelike these devices become, the weirder it is to hear your child rudely demanding something from a humanlike voice.

What to do: Model the behavior you want to see. It might feel strange to say “please” to a machine, but if that’s what you expect from your kid, you should do it too. It might help explain to kids that even though you know Alexa doesn’t have feelings, using polite voices and words makes it nicer for the real people in the house who do have feelings. You can talk about how it can feel bad to be around someone who’s yelling or angry, even if they’re not yelling at you.

22. The phrase **nibble away at** in Paragraph 4 is closest in meaning to _____.

- A) deteriorate B) empower C) stand by D) wipe out

23. According to the text, we can know that Alexa _____.

- A) fails to follow courteous audio commands
- B) is a household located in the United States
- C) resembles lifelike devices in various aspects
- D) is a home assistant with audio channel



Questions 24-31 (Suggested completion time: 30 minutes)

Directions: Read three passages about empathy. Answer the questions according to the passages.

Passage A

Being able to feel empathy in any situation is a skill. Empathy is usually taken as a piece of compassion-building. Here is a four-level hierarchy about the differences between apathy, sympathy, empathy and compassion.

Apathy = I don't care. You are unimportant to me.

Sympathy = I see you and I feel sorry about your plight. (This can feel like one-up/one-down. The person I "feel

sympathy for” may feel pitied—which doesn’t feel good. But this is a step up from apathy. I might donate money or express concern from sympathy.)

Empathy = I feel what you feel. This is a peer-to-peer experience. (When you are sad, I feel the sadness in my body/mind/heart. This has a genuine caring texture to the person who is suffering. But you might feel like you are riding the roller coaster of emotions. You and I might feel unsafe and distance ourselves if feeling another's pain becomes too much.)

Compassion = I feel what you feel and it doesn't overwhelm me. (I modulate my emotional state with my wisdom. I see a larger picture. I act skillfully to relieve suffering where I can, or to sit with people who just need accompaniment in their pain or their joy.)

We may begin with apathy for someone or something. Then we may learn how to have sympathy for the suffering of others. Empathy moves us to feel with, to suffer with or rejoice with others. From empathy we can build to the next step—compassion. Compassion is distinguished by its universality and by the lack of panic or fear in it. Empathy at a global level is overwhelming. Compassion is not overwhelming because it is partnered with wisdom. Compassion *sees a larger picture*.

In spiritual intelligence, there is no path to compassion that doesn't take us through empathy first. Empathy, defined as "sensing others' feelings and perspectives, and taking an active interest in their concerns", is a core emotional intelligence (EQ) skill and definitely plays a significant role in developing many of the social skills.

Passage B

We tend to think of the capacity to feel empathy as a good thing. If we're not able to put ourselves in someone else's shoes to feel their pain, then aren't we lacking a fundamental piece of what makes us human? Paul Bloom, developmental psychologist and author of *Against Empathy: The Case for Rational Compassion* disagrees. "I argue that empathy is biased," says Paul. "It's innumerate; it's irrational; it leads us to all sorts of moral mistakes; it's a catalyst for violence and cruelty. We're much better off combining rationality, a sense of the right thing to do, cost and benefits and so on, with compassion—kindness towards others. Basically, if you feel other people's pain, it motivates you to want to help them. And in the short term, with just one person around, that's great. But when you start using this as a way to direct policy and criminal justice and when to go to war, it has horrible consequences."

Part of the problem is not so much that empathy drives us to help people, but it dictates who we want to help. We're more compelled to feel the pain of people who are close to us in some way—our friends, family, people who look like us, and people who belong to the same ethnicity. But people who are out of sight on the other side of the world, or are seen as enemies, or in some way frighten or disgust us don't evoke empathy. "Empathy directs help in a fundamentally biased way," says Paul.

And then there’ s the fact that empathy will direct us to focus on helping one person chosen by our own biases at the expense of focusing on bigger problems that potentially affect entire populations. “It’ s because of empathy we care more about a little girl stuck in a well than we do about the problem of climate change,” Paul says.

This speaks to perhaps the biggest reason to eschew empathy: it’ s not very efficient. Consider the medical staff in a hospital emergency room and how too much empathy would be a hindrance to their job performance. Lives would be lost if doctors and nurses couldn’ t be cool-headed enough to separate themselves from the pain their patients experience in order to do what it takes to alleviate that pain. And this is why even the most experienced surgeons in the world wouldn’ t generally be allowed to operate on their own child, spouse, or best friend.

Passage C

One death is a tragedy. One million is a statistic.

You’ ve probably heard this saying before. It is thought to capture an unfortunate truth about empathy: While a single crying child or injured puppy tugs at our heartstrings, large numbers of suffering people, as in epidemics or earthquakes, do not inspire a comparable reaction.

Studies have repeatedly confirmed this. It’ s a troubling finding because, as recent research has demonstrated, many of us believe that if more lives are at stake, we will—and should—feel more empathy and do more to help.

Not only does empathy seem to fail when it is needed most, but it also appears to play favourites. Recent studies have shown that our empathy is dampened or constrained when it comes to people of different races, nationalities or creeds. These results suggest that empathy is a limited resource, like a fossil fuel, which we cannot extend indefinitely or to everyone.

What, then, is the relationship between empathy and morality?

Traditionally, empathy has been seen as a force for moral good, motivating virtuous deeds. Yet a growing chorus of critics, inspired by findings like those above, depicts empathy as a source of moral failure. In the word of one psychologist, empathy is a “parochial, narrow-minded” emotion—one that “will have to yield to reason if humanity is to survive” .

We disagree.

While we concede that the exercise of empathy is, in practice, often far too limited in scope, we dispute the idea that this shortcoming is inherent, a permanent flaw in the emotion itself. Inspired by a competing body of recent research, we believe that empathy is a choice that we make whether to extend ourselves to others. The “limits” to our empathy are merely apparent, and can change, sometimes drastically, depending on what we want to feel.

Two decades ago, psychologist Daniel Batson and colleagues conducted a study that showed that if people expected their empathy to cost them significant amounts of money or time, they would avoid situations that they believed would trigger it. More recently, Daryl Cameron, an assistant professor, along with psychologist Keith Payne, conducted an experiment to see if similar motivational factors could explain why we seem

more empathetic to single victims than to large numbers of them.

Participants in this study read about either one or eight child refugees from the Darfur region of Sudan. Half of the participants were led to expect that they would be asked to make a donation to the refugee or refugees, whereas the other half were not. When there was no financial cost involved in feeling empathy, people felt more empathy for the eight children than for the one child, reversing the usual bias. If insensitivity to mass suffering stemmed from an intrinsic limit to empathy, such financial factors shouldn't have made a difference.

Even those suffering from so-called empathy deficit disorders appear to be capable of empathy when they want to feel it. Research found that when dividing money between themselves and others, people with psychopathic tendencies were more charitable when they believed that the others were part of their in-group. These people are able to feel empathy; it's just that they don't typically want to.

Arguments against empathy rely on an outdated view of emotion as a capricious beast that needs to yield to sober reason. Yes, there are many situations in which empathy appears to be limited in its scope, but this is not a deficiency in the emotion itself. Empathy is only as limited as we choose it to be.

24. The phrase *sees a larger picture* in Passage A most probably means ____.

- A) integrates useful information thoroughly
- B) overlooks unimportant details intentionally
- C) understands a situation comprehensively
- D) deals with complicated problems easily

25. Which of the following is TRUE about "empathy" according to Passage A?

- A) It is important for developing social skills.
- B) It will finally turn into compassion.
- C) It brings negative influence on emotions.
- D) It begins from the feeling of sympathy.

26. According to Passage B, which of the following is TRUE about Paul Bloom's attitude towards empathy?

- A) Ironical.
- B) Impartial.
- C) Critical. ✓
- D) Neutral.

27. According to Passage B, why are surgeons generally not allowed to operate on people who are close to them?

- A) Because empathy is generally irrational and may trigger violence and cruelty.
- B) Because empathy cannot effectively motivate people to make the right choice.
- C) Because empathy drives surgeons to help those who are chosen by their biases.
- D) Because empathy has negative influence on the job performance of surgeons.

28. Which of the following is the best title for Passage C?

- A) New Studies on Empathy
- B) Empathy Is a Choice
- C) How to Be Empathetic
- D) One Death vs. One Million

29. What does the experiment mentioned in Passage C demonstrate?

- A) Large numbers of suffering people need more financial support than a single victim does. C) One's sense of mass suffering depends on whether donation of money is required or not.
B) People seem more empathetic to one child refugee than to eight refugees in poverty. D) Financial factor is one of the motivational factors influencing people's feeling of empathy.

Decide whether the following statements are True or False according to the three passages.

30. All the three passages agree that empathy is an important and fundamental feeling of people although one may be painful when feeling it.

- A) True B) False

31. None of the three passages is in support of the idea that empathy is a wiser choice to deal with other people's suffering.

- A) True B) False

32.

Question 32 (Suggested completion time: 40 minutes)

Directions: *Read an excerpt from The Story of Mankind by Hendrik Willem van Loon about Napoleon. Write a short essay according to the excerpt.*

Napoleon was what is called a fast worker. His career does not cover more than twenty years. In that short span of time he fought more wars and gained more victories and marched more miles and conquered more square kilometers and killed more people and brought about more reforms and generally upset Europe to a greater extent than anybody had ever managed to do.

He was a little fellow and during the first years of his life his health was not very good. He never impressed anybody by his good looks and he remained to the end of his days very clumsy whenever he was obliged to appear at a social function. He did not enjoy a single advantage of breeding or birth or riches. For the greater part of his youth he was desperately poor and often he had to go without a meal or was obliged to make a few extra pennies in curious ways.

He gave little promise as a literary genius. When he competed for a prize offered by the Academy of Lyons, his essay was found to be next to the last and he was number 15 out of 16 candidates. But he overcame all these difficulties through his absolute and unshakable belief in his own destiny, and in his own glorious future. Ambition was the main-spring of his life. The thought of self, the worship of that capital letter "N" with which he signed all his letters, and which recurred forever in the ornaments of his hastily constructed palaces, the absolute will to make the name Napoleon the most important thing in the world next to the name of God, these desires carried Napoleon to a pinnacle of fame which no other man has ever reached.

When he was a half-pay lieutenant, young Bonaparte was very fond of the "Lives of Famous Men" which Plutarch, the Roman historian, had written. But he never tried to live up to the high standard of character set by these heroes of the older days. Napoleon seems to have been devoid of all those considerate and thoughtful sentiments which make men different from the animals. It will be very difficult to decide with any degree

of accuracy whether he ever loved anyone besides himself. He kept a civil tongue to his mother, but Letizia had the air and manners of a great lady and after the fashion of Italian mothers, she knew how to rule her brood of children and command their respect. For a few years he was fond of Josephine, his pretty Creole wife, who was the daughter of a French officer of Martinique and the widow of the Vicomte de Beauharnais. But the Emperor divorced her when she failed to give him a son and heir and married the daughter of the Austrian Emperor, because it seemed good policy.

Write a short essay of about 300 words based on your understanding of the excerpt. Remember to write in your OWN words. Your essay should respond to the following questions:

- 1) What is the general attitude of the excerpt towards Napoleon?
- 2) What kind of person was Napoleon according to the excerpt? What exactly was it that brought him to glory?
- 3) Do you agree with the excerpt on the subject of Napoleon? Please explain your reasons.